

NATAL LILY

Clivia miniata

I bought a Clivia for my parents 15 years ago, and every year my dad calls me to tell me it's flowering again. I'm not surprised at his excitement, because this plant has the most spectacular flowers and blooms annually. The real beauty is the color combination: the vibrant tangerine flowers almost glow against the deep emerald foliage.

“I'll bring happiness with my bright blooms.”

Help me thrive



POSITION

To encourage flowering, place in a well-lit, cool conservatory or any bright, unheated room from late fall until buds form in early spring.



POTTING

Doesn't like being disturbed, so repot by one size up, using a well-drained, loam-based compost, only when it's bursting from its container.



GROWTH RATE

This plant can grow up to 1½ft (45cm) tall and 1ft (30cm) wide. It is slow growing, so it may take 2–5 years to reach maturity.



CARE

Water freely, letting the top of the soil dry out before watering again, and feed weekly in spring and summer. In the winter months, water sparingly.



I am symbolic

My blooms are long-lasting, so I have come to signify long life. I became a popular indoor plant in the Victorian era and inside the palaces of the last Chinese imperial dynasty because of my symbolic longevity. I don't mean to show off, but in Changchun I am the city's emblem.



Help me feel at home

I am a distinctive and beautiful foliage plant. My dark-green, swordlike leaves will stay blemish-free if I'm not put into a room that is too hot or too dry. When the temperature drops in the winter, stand me on a tray of wet pebbles to make the atmosphere a little more humid.